Victory). As the victorious Padshah approached the city, the joy of the people spilled over like a pomegranate cracked open. The musicians of the naqqar khana, above the entrance to the city, prepared their drums, cymbals, and curved and long trumpets. Akbar waited for all his warriors outside the capital; on 5 October, the Padshah mounted a grey horse and, with a spear in his hand, directed all his liegemen to ride behind him holding spears or lances. In the saturated dusk, the victorious Mughal warriors rode into Fatehpur Sikri where Hamida Banu Begum, the other begums, the three princes, and all the impatient amirs and soldiery broke into cheers and cacophonous music and exuberant joy.

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*Also known as the Gulf of Cambay.
*The Arabic word Habashi, for Abyssinia, the old name for Ethiopia.
†Now titled khan azam.
*Hindus of the merchant class.
*Abu'l Fazl, more reliable, puts this number at 1,000 at this stage. It would reach 4,000 at the time of Akbar's death.
*In popular Muslim belief, a spiritual and temporal leader who would restore religion before the end of the world.
*A Timurid nobleman.
*Akbar's armour can be viewed at the Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya. The reader will allow me a little liberty of a few years, as this particular armour is dated 1581.
†The imperial standard, used since the time of Timur.
*On learning that the dead man was heavily indebted, Akbar paid all Saif Khan's dues on his return to Agra.
*They were put to death by order of Rai Singh.
*The gaz or yard, which was 4 digits or 33 inches in length, was adopted as a national measure.
†All land would be classified into four categories on the basis of the continuity of its cultivation.